



Beginner — School

Level A1–A2 • Speaking Activity • Present tense • Use the sentence starters to help you answer.



Conversation Questions

1. What school do you go to? What is it like?

PRESENT → I go to _____. It is _____. The school has _____. Every day we _____.

2. What subjects do you study? Which one do you like most and why?

PRESENT → I study _____. My favorite subject is _____ because _____. I also like _____.

3. How do teachers and students behave in your school or country?

PRESENT → Teachers are _____. Students are _____. In my school, we always / never _____.

4. What challenges do you face at school? How do you handle them?

PRESENT → One challenge is _____. I handle it by _____ing. It is hard because _____.

5. How is school in the United States different from school in your home country?

PRESENT → In my country, school is _____. Here, school is _____. One difference is _____.

★ **Bonus:** After each answer, ask: 'What about you?' or 'Do you also _____?' | Remember: use present tense — I go, I study, It is, There are.



Word Bank

go to school

I go to school every day. (present tense)

study

I study math and English. (present tense)

learn

I learn new things in class. (present tense)

have class

I have class in the morning. (present tense)

teacher

a person who teaches students in school

student

a person who goes to school to learn

subject

a topic taught in school: math, science, etc.

homework

school work you do at home

test / exam

questions that check what you know

schedule

a list of classes and times for your school day



Intermediate — School

Level B1–B2 • Speaking Activity • Past tense • Expand your answers — aim for 3–4 sentences.



Conversation Questions

1. What school do you go to / did you go to? What is / was it like?

PAST → I attended _____. It was _____. The school had _____. My experience there was _____.

2. What subjects do you study / did you study? Which did you enjoy most and why?

PAST → I studied _____. My favorite subject was _____ because _____. I also enjoyed _____.

3. How do / did teachers and students behave in your school or country?

PAST → Teachers were _____. Students were expected to _____. One thing I noticed was _____.

4. What challenges do / did you face at school? How do / did you handle them?

PAST → One challenge I faced was _____. I handled it by _____ing. It taught me _____.

5. How is / was school in the United States different from school in your home country?

PAST → In my country, school was _____. Here, it is _____. The biggest difference I found was _____.

★ **Bonus:** Add a detail or reflection after each answer. | Try: 'Looking back...' / 'At the time, I...' / 'That experience taught me...'



Word Bank

attended went to school regularly (past tense of attend)	required was needed or mandatory (past tense)
studied learned about a subject (past tense of study)	curriculum all the subjects and content taught in a school
graduated finished and received a diploma or degree (past)	grading system the way a school measures student progress
struggled with found something difficult (past tense)	environment the overall atmosphere and conditions of a place
excelled at was very good at something (past tense)	expectation what a teacher or school believed students should do



Advanced — School

Level C1–C2 • Speaking Activity • Past tense + causative verbs: let, make, have.



Conversation Questions

1. What school do you go to / did you go to? What is / was it like?

PAST + CAUSATIVE → My school let me / made me / had me _____. Looking back, that environment shaped me by _____.

2. What subjects do you study / did you study? Which did you enjoy most and why?

PAST + CAUSATIVE → That subject made me ____ / let me ____ / had me _____. It influenced the way I think about _____.

3. How do / did teachers and students behave in your school or country?

PAST + CAUSATIVE → Teachers let students ____ / made students ____ / had students _____. Reflect on how authority shaped the learning culture.

4. What challenges do / did you face at school? How do / did you handle them?

PAST + CAUSATIVE → That challenge made me ____ / let me ____ / had me _____. Analyze how difficulty contributed to your growth.

5. How is / was school in the United States different from school in your home country?

PAST + CAUSATIVE → The U.S. system lets / made me ____ while my home country had me _____. Compare educational philosophies and their long-term impact.

★ **Bonus:** Push deeper with causative follow-ups. | Try: 'Did that system let you...?' / 'What did it make you realize?' / 'Did it have you changing how you...?'



Word Bank

let (causative)

allowed someone to do something → My school let me choose my classes.

make (causative)

forced or caused someone to do something → It made me think critically.

have (causative)

arranged for someone to do something → They had us present weekly.

pedagogy

the theory and practice of how teaching and learning happen

autonomy

the freedom to make your own choices in learning

critical thinking

the ability to analyze and evaluate information carefully

shaped

influenced or formed over time (past tense of shape)

instilled

gradually taught a value or habit over time (past tense)

equity

fair access to resources and opportunities for all students

reflected on

thought carefully about a past experience (past tense)

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